

KaOS Linux 2023.09 Adds KDE Gear 23.08, Focus To Shift On KDE Plasma 6 ISO

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KaOS 2023.09 is here almost three months after the previous ISO release, KaOS 2023.07, which only added a few minor updates compared to the KaOS 2023.06 release. The new ISO snapshot is powered by the Linux 6.4 kernel series and includes the latest KDE Gear 23.08 software suite, alongside the KDE Plasma 5.27.8 and KDE Frameworks 5.110 updates. Of course, KDE Plasma 5.27 LTS is still used as the default desktop environment in KaOS 2023.09. Under the hood, the KaOS 2023.09 release includes OpenSSL 3.1.3, Boost 1.82.0, ICU 73.2, ALSA 1.2.10, systemd 253.10, Python 3.10.13, Util-Linux 2.39.2, IWD 2.8, OpenEXR 3.2.0, libarchive 3.7.2, and Qt 5.15.10. Since KaOS follows a rolling-release model, existing KaOS Linux users need only to update their installations by running the `sudo pacman -Syu` command in the Terminal app.

The development team behind the Arch Linux-inspired, KDE-oriented, and independently developed KaOS Linux distribution announced today the general availability of KaOS 2023.09 as a new, up-to-date installation image with some of the latest GNU/Linux technologies and Open Source software.

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Of course, KDE Plasma 5.27 LTS is still used as the default desktop environment in KaOS 2023.09. However, the team also updated the KDE Plasma 6 Preview ISO and they plan to concentrate more of their efforts on developing and updating the Plasma 6 ISO, which will become the default for KaOS Linux by the end of the year.

“This ISO is still Plasma 5 based and includes all the latest updates, but Plasma 5 & Qt5 are not where upstream development is anymore. Plan is to have this or the November ISO be the last Plasma 5 based stable ISO, after that, it will be Plasma 6 only,” said the devs.

The KDE Project plans to release the highly anticipated KDE Plasma 6 desktop environment sometime in February 2024, but it looks like KaOS Linux could be the first distro to ship Plasma 6 as the default desktop for its stable ISO release and not as a preview image.

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If you want to give this distro a try, KaOS Linux 2023.09 is available for download from the official website or by using the direct download links below with both the KDE Plasma 5 and Plasma 6 desktops.

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